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RETAIN

How Britain Became as Poor as Mississippi: A Cautionary Tale

The Atlantic piece examines the UK long-term productivity stagnation, linking it to underinvestment, regulatory rigidity, and talent outflows stemming from both Brexit and systemic failures. The British case illustrates how even a developed economy can regress without deliberate skilled-retention policy and R&D; investment.

3R: For Ukraine, which will build a new economic architecture post-war, the UK experience is a warning: reconstruction without retaining highly skilled professionals and stimulating productivity can entrench poverty. This directly informs the Retain pillar — conditions for skills application and R&D; environment building.

Uzbekistan Formalizes Labor Migration Pathways to the US

Uzbekistan is transitioning from irregular migration to bilateral training and employment agreements with the US, seeking to institutionalize labor outflows as a source of remittances and competency transfer. This reflects a broader global trend toward managed labor migration among labor-surplus countries.

3R: The Uzbek case is relevant to the Return pillar: it shows how countries with active migration flows attempt to maintain diaspora connections through formal mechanisms. For Ukraine, which has a significantly more skilled migrant cohort, this signals the need for analogous bilateral frameworks for knowledge circulation — with emphasis on return, not merely remittances.

THE DIPLOMAT
